Hosting your Retreat at Villa Koukouvayia Farms: Answers to some FAQs



Finding a Best Fit for Your Program…and Participants

Villa Koukouvayia Farms will serve as the perfect place to lodge your group and platform your program, whether its focus be recreational, historical, culinary, health & yoga, or creative and practical arts. As a dedicated retreat center, the estate offers both easy integration between your program's home and its activities.

Of course, while your program itself might easily highlight your planning attention, let's talk first about how Villa Koukouvayia Farms can serve to lodge your participants for the days that will platform your program's experience.

Lodging at Villa Koukouvayia Farms

Villa Koukouvayia Farms is a unique property, with unique residences, rooms and capacities. By design, she is not a hotel filled with a bank of identical rooms, but a home to share with those who want such ambience. And while her lodging capacities are unique, their flexibility is her greatest asset, for a large family or friendship group seeking a unified estate for gathering, or a strategic program needing a coherent campus for multiple private individuals to learn and grow as a team.

To ensure that your group's lodging needs are comfortably met, review the table below. The numbers describe, from a variety of perspectives, the estate's sleeping capacities. They include what is possible and what we might suggest based on your group's needs.

Villa Koukouvayia Lodging Capacities	VKF Estate	Main House	Guest House	Garden Suite
Private Bedrooms:	8	3	2	3
Single Beds:	14	1	2	11
Couple's Bedding:	6	2	1	3
Full Baths:	5	2	1	2
Half-Baths:	2	1	1	0
Nominal Sleeping Capacity:	15—20	5	4	6—11
Additional Sleep Areas:	6	3	2	1
Additional Single Bedding Available:	6	4	2	0
Additional Couple's Bedding Available:	1	0	0	1
Additional Sleeping Capacity:	8	4	2	2
Max Capacity Recommended:	24	7	4	13
Max Capacity Allowed:	28	9	6	13

Note: For programs needing capacities beyond Villa Koukouvayia, or with a desire to house facilitators nearby vs. onsite, we have relationships with several nearby homes—one of which is a charming private cottage only a few steps through the olive groves from VKF's estate. We can often secure these homes at discounted rates and easily integrate the cost within your invoice.

Occupancies Included & Available

To fairly price a variety of group sizes, we set base rates to allow inexpensive stays for smaller groups, then use a supplement (€13/extra-guest/night) to let larger groups match costs to their lodging needs & value. The next table specifies guests included in the rates that follow, & those allowed at extra charge.

Guest Capacities	VKF Estate	Main House	Guest House	Garden Suite
Guests Included in Base Rate:	16	6	4	6
Extra Guests Allowed w/Supplement:	12	3	2	7

Note: Infants under 2 years at the time of arrival are not counted in these limits or pricing.

Calculating Costs

Your costs will include two elements: lodging your group and arranging the services that integrate your activities with the destination of Crete to ensure that both are effective. In whatever capacity we might participate, our goal is to be fair & transparent in our charges, and to avoid surprises once you decide to stay with us. For instance, Greek taxes paid on your behalf are progressive, confusing and high. To keep your costs low we cap the rental tax @ the VAT rate of 24%. To ensure you don't worry about *any* of it, we include every tax in the worksheets below and will do the same in any offer we share with you. Simply put, we want you to know all costs before deciding to stay with us. (And if comparing Villa Koukouvayia's to others', make sure they too are fully inclusive!)

1. Lodging Rates

Costs for many activities and program elements will vary, but as the most stable & predictable expense, your group's lodging costs are a good place to start building your budget. The table below lists Villa Koukouvayia's base lodging rates by season. Each rate, multiplied by the days you will lodge your group, will include all lodging amenities from the afternoon of your arrival until the morning of your departure. As you can imagine, the majority of labor that creates your group's comfortable stay occurs in the fixed costs of preparing the estate. So that we can spread those expenses across lower rates and welcome shorter stays, we do have a minimum charge, easily calculated at 7x your nominal reservation rate. Should you prefer a shorter stay, an example at typical occupancy is shown in the table.

Season/Month	Lodging Daily Rate (16 guests)	Lodging Minimum
January & February	€ 295	€ 2,044
March & December	€ 357	€ 2,478
April & November	€ 399	€ 2,706
May & October	€ 499	€ 3,400
June & September	€ 629	€ 4,312
July & August	€ 790	€ 5,440

Note1: Rates include all taxes & fees, but as noted above, are priced to protect groups not bringing the maximum number of guests from being overcharged. For larger groups, add €13/night for each extra guest.

Note: To ensure your arrival's timing doesn't affect costs, reservations bridging multiple rate-seasons are calculated by each day within a seasonal rate, and the two subtotals are simply added.

2. Supplemental Services & Other Program Costs

Programs rarely thrive without support services provided during the program itself.

As professional retreat and program planners, we specialize in using this beautiful region of Crete—with its historic, culinary, topographic and recreational landscapes—to supercharge the experience at the heart of such gatherings. Transportation, food, activity &/or reservation services, either holistic or a la carte, and—most importantly—integrating all of those into experiences support your goals, while bringing people together to celebrate those goals and have fun. These services include:

- Arrival Support & Coordination for each guest, including communications, special requests & other individual guest services.
- Group transportation, including but not limited to vehicle arrangements and acquisition prior to arrivals; airport transfers at arrivals & departures, and off-campus activity, meal & miscellaneous transportation.

- Food & Beverage Support, including but not limited to catered meals and snack provisions, pantry stocking for internally prepared food provision, and arrangements with restaurants & tavernas for off-campus meals.
- Cleaning & Laundry Support ranging from simple daily or bi-weekly bathroom and towel service to full bedroom services at various frequencies.
- Activity Guide &/or Leadership, including but not limited to hikes, outings, Samaria Gorge traverses, historical tours, excursion expertise and guidance, and other customized experiences that fit your attendees' interests & abilities.

Such services are easily invoiced and at the following general rates:

- Third-party arrangements at 15% above their invoice.

  Note: With our local contacts, we often garner arrangements discounted more than this % charge, resulting in you paying the same or less for the service than if self-arranged.)

- General staffing (driving, guided excursions, etc.) at expenses (e.g., gas &/or food) plus €25/hour or €150/full-day.

Other Cost Considerations

The following details may not affect your costs but bear on your payments and how we coordinate the financial aspects of your stay.

Extended-Stay Discounts

We provide season-based discounts for programs lodging guests longer than two weeks.

Season/Month	14 Days	30 Days	60 Days
January & February	10%	15%	25%
March & December	7%	10%	20%
April & November	5%	7%	15%
May & October	3%	5%	10%
June & September	0%	3%	7%
July & August	0%	3%	5%

Note1: These discounts apply to base reservation costs before taxes or extra occupancy charges.

Note2: As with rates, discounts across "seasons," are calculated per-day, then subtotaled to ensure full deduction.

Reserving Your Time & Payment Plans

Smaller reservations are typically booked via full payment of the reservation's cost & security deposit. Larger reservations over €3,000 can qualify for 2, 3 or 4 payments depending on the reservation's value and the length of time between booking and your arrival. When you submit your inquiry, we will automatically calculate those options & share the details in our offer.

Damage/Security Deposits

While not affecting your net expense, once you decide to book with us, your initial payment will include a minimum security-deposit to hold that time against other requests and then later to serve as a damage-deposit during your stay. We set these amounts low to reflect typical guests but will increase them for groups that present a higher likelihood of damage, such as those bringing pets, youth groups, etc.

Of course, assuming no major issues, deposits are always returned via bank transfer at departure.

Security/Reservation Deposits	Estate	Youth Groups
Security/Damage Deposits:	€1,000	€1,000
Pet Damage Deposit Supplement (Max 2):	€200/pet	

Note: We never confuse 'damage' with 'use.' Yes, we assume you will ensure your group respects Villa Koukouvayia, but we also expect you to use the facility and enjoy yourself during your stay. And we've been hosting groups long enough to understand that any gathering of happy people—particularly if happy children are part of the mix—will drop a glass or two. And while we don't like broken glass, we do like it when you're happy!

Cancellation Policy

We will always work to rebook cancelled stays, will refund all payments to the degree we have rebooked that time, and we will never charge a fee for this service. While this is often easily done, especially with an early warning of your need to cancel, it cannot be guaranteed

Currency

As our location demands, we charge in Euros. We can accept USD payment if you wish, and unlike all other banks, card-processors and third-party platforms, our offer will reflect the simple IMF exchange rate on the day we make that offer, and held for 7 days beyond, with no surcharges or extra fees.

Payment Methods

We encourage direct (IBAN or, in the USA, intrabank) transfers that are easy, safe and free. We *can* accept payments through credit cards and are happy to do so, but unlike larger third-party sites, we do not hide the inevitable payment-processing fees across all our rates and in doing so charge all customers the 3.5% to 5% fee from which only a few customers benefit. Card options and the processing details will be itemized in any offer we send, so you can choose a payment method that works best for you.

Any Other Questions?

Your program, like you, should be special. So call us. Let's set up a video-chat where you can share your goals and hopes for your program, and we'll be honored to help!

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